



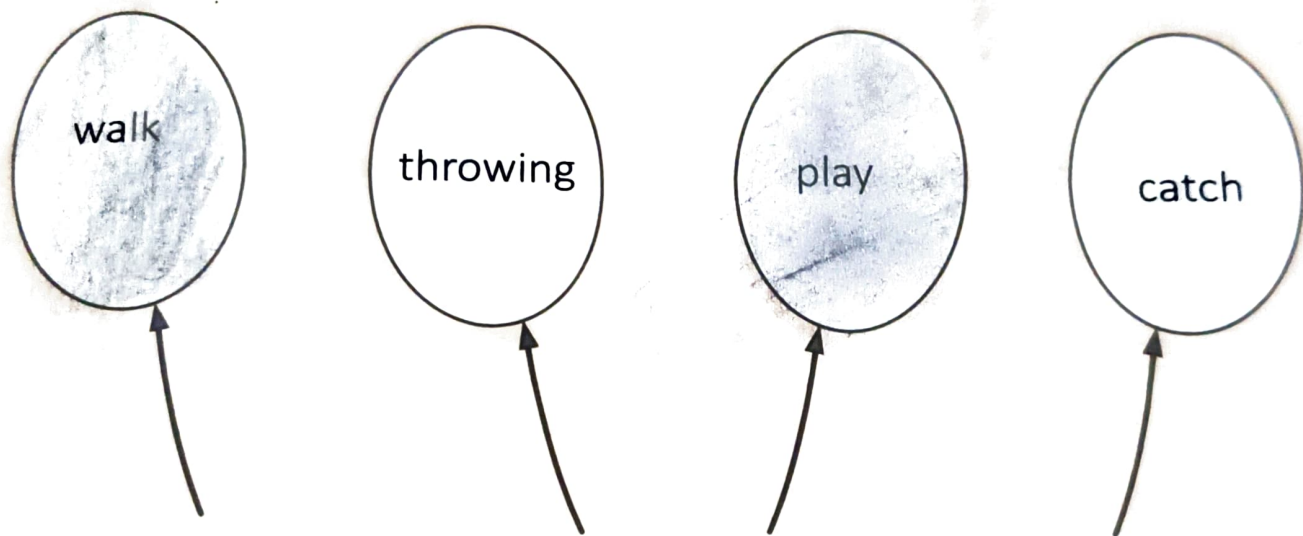
CHAPTER

12

Present tense

Get cracking

Colour the balloons that carry verbs in simple present tense.



Know more

A All verbs have tenses. Tenses can be in *present*, *past* or *future*. They tell the time of a particular action.

Read the sentences below.

1. Children go to school every day.
2. Grandmother bakes cookies once a month.
3. The sun rises in the east.

The highlighted words in the above sentences are all verbs.

- These verbs are in the simple present tense. **Simple present tense** is used to express something in general or activities that happen regularly. It is also used to state a universal fact.

B Study the table. Note how the verb forms change.

	Singular	Plural
First person	I <u>spea</u> k.	We <u>speak</u> .
Second person	You <u>speak</u> .	You <u>speak</u> .
Third person	He/She/It <u>spea</u> ks.	They <u>speak</u> .

- In the simple present tense, we use the root form of the verb with the pronouns *I*, *you*, *we* and *they*.
- In the simple present tense, we add *-s* or *-es* to the verb, if used with the pronouns *she*, *he* and *it*.

C Complete the sentences choosing the **present verbs** given in the brackets.

- I enjoy (enjoy/enjoys) the morning breeze every day.
- My father writes (writes/write) to my uncle once a month.
- He visits (visit/visits) the library in the evening.
- You should eat (eat/eats) a lot of fruits.
- We go (go/goes) to the school by bus.
- She takes (take/takes) care of her pet kitten.
- A car moves (move/moves) faster than a bicycle.
- They love (love/loves) exploring new places.
- The puppet show starts (start/starts) at 6 pm.
- The Earth revolves (revolves/revolve) around the Sun.

D Circle the correct option. One has been done for you.

1. She know/knows how to speak French.
2. He drinks/drink tea at breakfast.
3. They drives/drive to Shimla every summer.
4. You draw/draws beautiful pictures.
5. Water freeze/freezes at zero degrees.
6. Our teacher gives/give us a test every week.
7. Farmers works/work hard to grow crops.
8. He read/reads a storybook at bedtime.
9. I keep/keeps my wardrobe neat and tidy.
10. It snow/snows a lot in winter in Russia.

E Present continuous tense

Read the sentences below.

I am reading a book.

I was reading a book

She is playing a piano.

- The above sentences are in present continuous tense.

The **present continuous tense** shows an action that is still happening at the time of speaking.

- In the present continuous tense, we use **is**, **are** or **am** with the root form of the verb + **-ing**.

Remember

we/you/they/all plural nouns

he/she/it/all singular nouns

am

speak (root verb) + -ing

are

speak (root verb) + -ing

is

speak (root verb) + -ing

Verb + ing

F Fill in the blanks with the present continuous form of the verbs given in the brackets. One has been done for you.

1. I am getting ready for school. (get)
2. The cat is hiding behind the curtain. (hide)
3. Grandmother is telling us stories of Akbar and Birbal. (tell)
4. Hurry! The train is leaving the platform. (leave)
5. They are dancing to the music. (dance)
6. Don't go outside! It is raining. (rain)
7. Harshit and I am doing our homework together. (do)
8. She is waiting for her friend at the coffee shop. (wait)
9. The shy boy is sitting quietly at the corner. (sit)
10. The teacher is teaching tenses to the students. (teach)

G Fill in the blanks with the simple present or present continuous forms of verbs. One has been done for you.

1. I eat burgers. But today I am eating pizza.
2. You go to school by bus. But today you are going by car.
3. Arjun play badminton. But today he is playing tennis.
4. We go to the park for one hour daily. But today we are going for half an hour.
5. The fisherman Catch fish every day with his net. But today he is catching with his fishing pole.